



INTER-ZONAL MULTI-DAY TROPHY: FORESIGHT FROM BCCI, BUT MISPLACED IN A WHITE-BALL WORLD?

India's return to red-ball cricket amidst a landscape dominated by shorter formats and limited support for women's Tests **poses an intriguing question**.

Lavanya Lakshmi Narayanan
lavanya.ln@thehindu.co.in

The scorching afternoon sun beat down upon the Maharashtra Cricket Stadium in Pune, setting the stage for a gripping showdown in the Senior Inter-Zonal Multi-Day Trophy final between East and South Zone. With temperatures hovering around 39°C, the empty stands witnessed a tense battle where every run and wicket mattered.

In a nail-biting 30-minute passage of play, East's Titas

Sadhu and Annapurna Das thwarted a determined South, led by Minnu Mani, clinching a one-wicket victory in the summit clash.

After a six-year hiatus, the tournament returned to India's domestic cricket calendar, featuring six teams competing for top honours over a fortnight in Pune.

The South and North Zones secured direct places in the